



BHYLLS ACRE PRIMARY SCHOOL **Policy for dealing with Compliments and Complaints**

**(a policy for parents, staff
and all anyone connected with the school)**

We welcome suggestions for improving our work in school and also enjoy hearing about the things that we are doing well. Be assured that, no matter what you want to tell us, our support and respect for your child/work will not be affected in any way. Please tell us of your concern as soon as possible. It is difficult for us to investigate an incident or problem properly if it took place some time ago. We do appreciate the assistance we receive from parents in addressing any problems that arise.

We receive very few complaints. Problems sometimes arise from misunderstandings which are easily addressed. Most concerns and complaints can be sorted out quickly by speaking with your child's class teacher. When parents and teachers treat each other with mutual respect and support, this provides a very good role model for all our children.

Compliments

We enjoy hearing about what you think we are doing well. Many parents already do this either by sending a letter or an email. The termly questionnaire provides an opportunity to share your views and OFSTED 'Parent View' is available on our website.

Complaints

If, having spoken to the class teacher/member of staff, you still have concerns, you should see the Headteacher. She will investigate the problem and discuss the findings with you so that we can find a way forward together which serves the best interest of the school and your child/you. In the unlikely event of the problem remaining unresolved you can put your complaint in writing and, if necessary, could subsequently refer it to the Chair of Governors.

The procedure to be followed in the event of a complaint being made is summarized in the following stages:

Stage 1: Informal Action

- Parents/staff discuss concerns with the relevant member of staff
- If the matter cannot be resolved easily, a clear note is made, including complainant's name, phone number and date. The teacher/ member of staff with the complaint may also consult the Headteacher at this stage.

- The teacher or headteacher ensures that the parent/staff is clear what action or monitoring of the situation has been agreed.
- If no satisfactory solution has been found, parents/member of staff is asked if they wish their concern to be considered further.

Stage 2: Referral to the Headteacher

- The Headteacher acknowledges the complaint, orally or in writing, within 3 working days
- A meeting is arranged with the complainant to clarify and supplement any information given.
- The Headteacher investigates further, interviewing witnesses as appropriate. If the complaint centers on a pupil, the pupil would normally be interviewed with a parent present or, if this is not possible, with a member of staff who is not directly involved.
- The Headteacher keeps written records of meetings, telephone conversations and other documentation.
- Once all relevant facts have been established, the Headteacher responds. If the complaint was in writing, a written response will be sent.
- If the complainant is not satisfied, they are advised to write to the Governing Body

If the complaint is against the Headteacher, the Stage 2 procedures are carried out by the Chair of the Governing Body.

Stage 3: Review by the Governing Body

- The Chair acknowledges receipt of the written complaint, informing the complainant that the complaint is to be heard by a Committee of three members of the School's Governing Body within 20 working days.
- The Chair arranges to convene a Complaints Panel elected from members of the Governing Body. The members should have no prior involvement with the complaint and they should elect a Chair for the committee. All relevant documentation regarding the complaint should be given to the members of the committee as soon as possible.
- The Chair of the Committee will write and inform all concerned of the date, time and place of the meeting at least 5 working days in advance. The notification to the complainant should also inform him/her of the right to be accompanied to the meeting by a friend and the right to submit further written evidence.
- It is the responsibility of the Chair of the Committee to ensure that the minutes of the meeting are properly recorded.

- After the meeting, the Committee will consider the evidence and a written decision will be sent to the Headteacher and the complainant within 15 working days.

Stage 4: Beyond the Governing Body

The Role of Staffordshire County Council (Local Authority)

The Local Authority does **not** have a statutory duty to consider school complaints and you do **not** have a right of appeal to the Local Authority should you disagree with a decision of the governing body. You may, however, raise the matter with the Local Authority if you consider the complaint wasn't investigated properly or fairly. So long as the governing body followed a proper procedure and considered the complaint in a reasonable manner, then the Local Authority will simply inform you of the fact. It cannot reverse a decision of the governing body.

If you wish to raise a matter with Staffordshire County Council please write to:

Commissioner for Learning and Skills
Wedgewood Building
Tipping Street
Stafford
ST16 2DH

In your letter please explain:

- What your complaint to the governing body was;
- What response they have made to it;
- Why you think that the governing body has not followed a proper procedure in considering your complaint, and/or
- Why you think that their consideration of it was unreasonable.

You will receive a written response to inform you of any further enquiries made into your complaint.

The Role of the Secretary of State for Education (the Department for Education)

If you still remain dissatisfied and feel that the School has not followed the appropriate procedure, any relevant policies, or has failed to discharge a

statutory duty, you may wish to refer your complaint to the School's Complaint Unit (SCU) within the Department for Education at the address below:-

The School's Complaints Unit
Department for Education
2nd Floor Piccadilly Gate
Manchester
M1 2WD

Please note that the SCU will not re-investigate the substance of the complaint as this remains the responsibility of the School, but if legislative or policy breaches are found, SCU will report them to School and, if necessary require the School to take remedial action.

Ratified by Governors on _____

Review due November 2016